America in Bible Prophecy

Purpose: *To identify the second beast of Revelation 13.*

Centred on: *The identification characteristics.*

*Read all of Revelation 13 and note the relational characteristics of the two Beasts!

Revelation 13: 11-12…. Another beast, That is, another in addition to the one already mentioned in verse 1. The Greek implies that it is of the same kind as the first beast and is confirmed as its characteristics are unfolded in verse 12. It works in close collaboration with the first beast.

Coming up: Gr. anabainō, "to ascend," "to rise," "to spring up." In **Matt. 13:7** anabainō is used of growing plants. The form of the Greek word calls attention to the process of gradual emergence.

First five identification marks:

1) Out of the earth (v 11): The first beast arose out of the sea (see verse 1). The four beasts of Dan. 7 also arose from the sea (verse 3). Since "sea" represents peoples, multitudes and nations (Rev. 13: 1; 17: 1, 2, 8), "earth" may reasonably be assumed to represent a sparsely occupied region. The nation thus represented would therefore not arise by war, conquest, and occupation, but would develop into greatness in a region of few inhabitants.

2) Arises at the same time the Sea Beast is falling (V 10): Grows into Nation-Hood about the time of Papal Overthrow (A.D. 1798).

When the first beast was going into captivity in 1798 (Rev 13:10), the United States was growing into prominence and power. The nation arose, not in the Old World, with its teeming multitudes, but in the New World, with its relatively few inhabitants.

3) Had two Horns like a lamb (V 11): Two Christ like principles give this nation its strength.

These may be taken to represent the two notable features of the American system of government, civil and religious liberty, both of which are guaranteed in the Constitution of the United States. Civil liberty found its expression in a republican form of government and religious liberty in Protestantism. **(See appendix).** A lamb is also a symbol of youthfulness and peaceful intent. Other nations have been described as wild beasts because of their warlike attitudes. This beast with the horns of a lamb could well indicate a nation that, in the beginning of its history, had no such aspirations. Its main concern was to live peacefully, order its own affairs, and be a haven of rest for the oppressed of many nations.

4) No crowns on Horns: Not a Monarchy, rather some form of republic perhaps?

5) Exercises power equal to the Sea Beast (v12): Becomes a formidable, if not a supreme world power.

Only one power in History meets these five prophetic specifications- **The United States of America!** This Nation was not established by military conquest like the kingdoms of Europe, but grew up quietly like a plant in the sparsely populated New World. It became a Nation in the latter half of the eighteenth century as the Papal power was crumbling. No Nation in History has dedicated itself more openly to the principles of Civil and Religious liberty. It is a republic not a Monarchy. It has made enormous gains in population, material wealth and military strength, especially during the past century, until today it is the richest and most powerful Nation on Earth.



Unfortunately, the prophecy does not end here. A radical and alarming change of character is predicted to take place in this favoured Nation, which began with such rich promise and noble ideas.

Revelation 13: 11… What is meant by *"Spoke like a Dragon?"*

There is a striking contradiction between the appearance and actions of the beast. In appearance it is gentle and apparently harmless, but in action it is persecuting and cruel, as vs. 12–18 reveal. When the prophecy is applied to the United States it is immediately apparent that fulfilment of the prediction is future. The United States today continues to maintain the principles of freedom guaranteed in the Constitution. The manner in which a change in policy will be brought about is outlined in the present prophecy. The change comes in connection with the final crisis immediately preceding the time when "the kingdoms of this world … become the kingdoms of our Lord and of his Christ" (Rev. 11: 15; Ps. 2: 2; Dan. 2: 44; 7: 14, 27).

History will yet witness on American soil the emergence of a State supported religious tyranny as ruthless as the Spanish inquisition of the Middle Ages, or the Iron fisted despotism of Imperial Rome!

Last five identification Marks:

1) Speaks as a Dragon (v 11): Undergoes a startling change from democracy to *absolutis.*

2) Enforces worship of the Sea Beast (v 12): Becomes a leader in the crusade for Papal restoration.

3) Deceives multitudes by working miracles (v 13): Exalts physical marvels as the ultimate proof of truth in religious matters.

4) Urges making of image to Sea Beast- Gives life to the image (v 14, 15): Creates in the New World Order a Church-State monopoly patterned on the Mediaeval Papacy.

What is meant by the "image" to the Beast?: *Image.* Gr. eikōn, "a likeness," "an image." In 2 Cor. 4:4 and Col. 1:15 Christ is spoken of as the eikōn of God. It is the purpose of the plan of salvation to transform man into the eikōn of Christ. An eikōn implies an archetype and in many respects is like its archetype. An image to the first beast would be an organization functioning on much the same principles as that beast's organization. Among the principles by which the first beast operated was the use of the secular arm to support religious institutions. In imitation the second beast will repudiate its principles of freedom. The church will prevail upon the state to enforce its dogmas. State and church will unite, and the result will be the loss of religious liberty and the persecution of dissenting minorities.

5) Enforces worship of image and reception of Mark of Sea Beast under pain of death (v 15, 16, 17): Repudiates man's basic freedoms-boycotts and persecutes Commandment-keeping minority!

Revelation 13: 17… *"…and that no one may buy or sell…"* The United States is the home of International finance and business. This one Nation contributes over 30% towards the total world's economy and has a dominating influence over the policy and actions of world trade. The amazing advances in technology have enabled the world Governments to move toward personal identity cards and a cashless economy. The "big brother" has arrived. Everything is set up for the final scenario where the government will determine who will "buy and sell."

Revelation 13: 15…*"…and cause as many as would not worship the image of the Beast to be killed…"* The United States has traditionally been known for its fairness and love of freedom. In recent years there have been shocking revelations of torture and death by the United States military and government. Amnesty International has documented horrific methods of torture at places such as Abu Ghraib prison, Guantanamo Bay and Afghanistan. Even the United States government has accepted that there are secret CIA prisons around the world, with many prisoners held without charge or trial.

Are there signs that this "image to the Beast" (Unification of Church & State), is now coming to life?

There are many ominous signs. Here are just a few:

- The work of the National Reform Administration. Dedicated to making America a "Christian Nation" by laws and penalties if persuasion fails.
- The activities of the "Lords day Alliance." Dedicated to the making and enforcement of Sunday laws, and Nation-wide observance of Sunday.
- The rapid growth of Roman Catholic power and influence in America.
- The retreat of Historic Protestantism.
- The strong Rome-ward current of the Ecumenical movement **(see appendix).**

So, according to the book of Revelation, religious freedom is facing its darkest, but finest hour! A crisis will yet develop in America and in every land of earth which will match the scene in ancient Babylon, when King Nebuchadnezzar set up his golden image, gathered his officers together and commanded them, on pain of death to bow down and worship (Dan 3: 1-7).

But when the moment of testing came, and the vast multitude bowed down in unity, there were three slim figures silhouetted against the sky- the figures of Shadrach, Meshach and Abed-nego. …***"let it be known to you O King,"*** they said, ***"that we do not serve your gods, nor will we worship the golden image which you have set up."*** (Dan 3: 18).

In every religious crisis of the past, God has found such men. When the laws of the State conflicted with the laws of God, these men prided themselves on the principle of…***"we ought to obey God rather than men"*** (Acts 5: 25). Will we be among them?

Appendix

Expressions of Civil and Religious Liberty:

"Every man conducting himself as a good citizen and being accountable to God alone for his religious opinions ought to be protected in worshiping the Deity according to the dictates of his own good conscious."

George Washington.

"When religion is good, it will take care of itself. When it is not able to take care of itself and God does not see fit to take care of it, so that it has to appeal to the civil power for support, it is evidenced in my mind that the cause is a bad one."

Benjamin Franklin.

Words of ecumenism:

"Perhaps most encouraging is the new ecumenism that permeates the pro-family community….The union of Roman Catholics and conservative Protestants could have a greater impact on American Politics than any coalition since African-Americans and Jews came together during the Civil rights movement."

Ralph Reed, *Politically Incorrect*, p13.

"Narrowing a major divide that has separated Roman Catholics and Lutherans since the 16th century, The United States largest Lutheran church on Tuesday, October 31, 1999, endorsed a joint declaration on how humans are saved from eternal damnation."

The Sacramento Bee, August 20, 1997. *Lutherans, Catholics settle dispute.*

"I believe that the emerging alliance (the emerging partnership of Catholics and Evangelical Protestants), is going to be the most powerful force in the electorate in the 1990's and beyond-and anybody that ignores that alliance is going to make a big mistake."

Fournier, Keith A & Watkins, William D, *A House United?: Evangelicals and Catholics Together : A Winning Alliance for the 21st Century,* January 15th 1995, Navpress. Forward by Pat Robertson.

Unity of Church and State:

The Papacy is by far the strongest religio-political power in the world today. Virtually every leading country of the world has an official ambassador or state representative at the Vatican. Note the following statements:

"The Papacy is so influential and powerful that nearly every major country consults with it before making major policy moves. Its large diplomatic corps maintains relations with more than 100 Nations."

U.S. News and World Report, October 30, 1978, p. 24.

It takes the credit for the demise of communism, saying that Mary, the mother of Jesus, guided the Popes strategy that bought down communism.

Time, December 30, 1991, pp. 64-65.

"The aim of the Pope is to unify the Christian world under the leadership of the Papacy. Pope John Paul II made more than 40 world trips to lay the ground work for his goal."

Hogberg, GH, *The Plain Truth*, November/December, 1989, pp. 24-25.

"The worldwide response has been almost overwhelming. During the Iraqi crisis, the Pope and the American President sometimes discussed world affairs weekly by phone."

U.S. News and World Report, August 13, 1990, p. 18.

"On June 7, 1982, former President Ronald Reagan and Pope John Paul II met for 50 minutes at the Vatican and structured a plan to eliminate communism. The United States shipped tones of modern communication equipment to Poland (the starting place) to help spread necessary information to the masses."

The Holy Alliance, *Time,* February, 1992, pp. 28, 31, 35.

Gorbachev said, "Everything which took place in Eastern Europe in recent years would have been impossible without the Pope's efforts and the enormous role, including the political role, which he played in the world arena."

Gorbachev, Mikhail, *Toronto Star*, March 9, 1992.

Vatican declares power over all governments:

"Undoubtedly it is the intention of the pope to possess this country. In this intention he is aided by the Jesuits, and all the Catholic prelates and priests."

Brownson's Review, May 1864.

"See, sir, from this Chamber, I govern, not only to Paris, but to China; not only to China, but to the entire world, without anyone knowing how I do it."

Tamburini, General of the Jesuits.

"Harmony between the different social classes must be re-established; peace must reign on earth. This is the task I intend to perform for you; this is the duty I promise to fulfil that all may once again be subject to the dominion of God, Jesus Christ and His Vicar on earth."

Saint Pius X, The New Italian Life Of The Saint, by Fr. Hieronymo Dal-Gal, translated and adapted by Rev. Thomas F. Murray, M.A., fourth revised impression, published by M. H. Gill and Son Ltd., 50 Upper O'Connell Street, 1954, pg. 104.

Speaking of the time, about 500 A.D., when the Roman Empire was crumbling to pieces:] "No, the [Catholic] Church will not descend into the tomb. It will survive the Empire . . . At length a second empire will arise, and of this empire the Pope will be the master--more than this, he will be the master of Europe. He will dictate his orders to kings who will obey them"

Andrea Lagarde, The Latin Church in the Middle Ages, 1915, p. vi.

"Fear, then, our wrath and the thunders of our vengeance; for Jesus Christ has appointed us [the popes] with his own mouth absolute judges of all men; and kings themselves are submitted to our authority."

Pope Nicholas I (858-867 AD).

"It is the office of the Papacy to tread under foot kings and emperors."

J.H. Ignaz Dollinger, in The Pope and the Council, (London), page 35.

"[It is error to believe that] The Church ought to be separated from the State, and the State from the Church."

Pope Pius IX, The Syllabus (of Errors), Issued in 1864, Section VI, Errors About Civil Society, Considered Both in Itself and in its Relation to the Church, #55.

"[It is error to believe that] Kings and princes are not only exempt from the jurisdiction of the Church, but are superior to the Church in deciding questions of jurisdiction."

Pope Pius IX, The Syllabus (of Errors), Issued in 1864, Section VI, Errors About Civil Society, Considered Both in Itself and in its Relation to the Church, #54.

"[It is error to believe that] In the case of conflicting laws enacted by the two powers (Church and civil), the civil law prevails."

Pope Pius IX, The Syllabus (of Errors), Issued in 1864, Section VI, Errors About Civil Society, Considered Both in Itself and in its Relation to the Church, # 42.

"Democracy is a mischievous dream where the Catholic Church does not predominate."

Brownson's Review.

"There is one, and only one, sure democracy, the Catholicism of the Popes"

The Catholic World, Oct, 1937.

The old Protestant culture is about at the end of its rope... Why can't we make the U.S. Catholic in legislation, Catholic in justice, aims and ideals?"

Father F. X. Talbot, editor of America, official Jesuit magazine for the U.S. statement in New York Globe Dec. 14, 1930.

"Religious liberty is merely endured until the opposite can be carried into effect without peril to the Catholic Church."

Bishop O'Conner of Pittsburg.

"If Catholics ever gain sufficient numerical majority in this country, religious freedom is at an end. So our enemies say; so we believe"

The Shepherd of the Valley, journal of the late bishop of St. Louis.

In the book Confusion Twice Confounded, Monsignor Joseph H. Brady states that the U.S. Supreme Court is wrong in decisions regarding "separation of Church and State." He says: "A sound view of the Constitution in its relation to religion probably awaits a change in personnel in our highest tribunal."

The Register, Jan. 23, 1955.

"But Constitutions can be changed, and non-Catholic sects may decline to such a point that the political proscription [ban] of them may become feasible and expedient. What protection would they have against a Catholic state?"

The State and the Church, pp.38,39, by Miller and Ryan, imprimatur of Cardinal Hayes.

"The Catholic Church in this nation must live on to accomplish her work, even though our Republican form of government disappears."

The Catholic World, April, 1935, p.12.

They [Catholics] must penetrate wherever possible in the administration of civil affairs... all Catholics should do all in their power to cause the constitution of states, and legislation to be modelled on the principles of the true Church."

Encyclical of Leo XIII.

Under the influence of Germanic customs and concepts, torture was little used from the 9th to the 12th centuries, but with the revival of Roman law the practice was re-established in the 12th century... In 1252 (Pope) Innocent IV sanctioned the infliction of torture by the civil authorities upon heretics, and torture came to have a recognized place in the procedure of the inquisitional courts.

New Catholic Encyclopedia, arts. "Inquisition", "Auto-da-Fe'," and "Massacre of St Bartholomew's Day."

Vatican seeks to abolish separation of Church & State:

"Consequently, John Paul was criticized by liberal and moderate politicians and newspapers for transgressing the boundary between church and state."

TIME June 1, 1981 article *"Not yet Hale, but Hearty"* By George Russell

In sermons based on the Ten Commandments, John Paul denounced excessive materialism, divorce, contraception and the separation of church and state,

TIME June 17, 1991 *"The Gift of Life"* p. 47 *Sermons from a Native Son*

Recent statements by the Polish Episcopate have fuelled apprehension. In late April the bishops urged that the new constitution exclude any provision for the separation of church and state. Instead, they suggested, "exceptional emphasis should be laid on the need for cooperation between the state and the Catholic Church."

TIME May 20, 1991 *"Five Who Could Be Vice President"* Pg 40 *"Power to the Pulpit"*

HOLY OFFICE STILL EXISTS

Pope John Paul II Revives Inquisition

The thought of a revived Holy Office of the Inquisition would pacify some and offend others. Nevertheless, the "Holy Office" still exists. Only its name has been changed. Pope John Paul II has been instrumental in its revival. One may argue that this Ratzinger run agency is merely an attempt by the Catholic Church to root out communism or backslidden priests and their practices. However, with John Paul II's objective to implement "God's mandate" by creating a global church-state which will administer from traditional Roman Catholic theology, is enough cause for alarm. Malachi Martin has already stated in his book, "The Keys of this Blood," that the pope will not tolerate any belief systems that oppose his, not on a civil or church level. In John Paul II the world will behold a tyrant who will coldly execute direct orders against those whom he deems are heretics or immoral. Moreover, like his papal predecessors, John Paul II will carry out his "Godly mandate" in the name of Christ, or perhaps Mary. May God help us all.

Kathleen R. Hayes Feb 1991, NRI Trumpet Page 3

“The Pope’s authority is unlimited, incalculable; it can strike, as Innocent III says, wherever sin is; it can punish every one; it allows no appeal and is itself Sovereign Caprice; for the Pope carries, according to the expression of Boniface VIII, all rights in the Shrine of his breast. As he has now become infallible, he can by the use of the little word, “orbi,” (which means that he turns himself round to the whole Church) make every rule, every doctrine, every demand, into a certain and incontestable article of Faith. No right can stand against him, no personal or corporate liberty; or as the [Roman Catholic] Canonists put it—“The tribunal of God and of the pope is one and the same.”

Ignaz von Dollinger, “A Letter Addressed to the Archbishop of Munich” 1871; as quoted in MacDougall, The Acton Newman Relations (Fordham University Press) pp. 119,120.

During the Reagan administration, President Ronald Reagan, after much pressure, appointed an ambassador to VATICAN CITY! When W. Kenneth Dan was asked why we need an ambassador in Vatican City, He replied; "It would allow the USA to influence the political decisions of the ROMAN CATHOLIC CHURCH!"

THIS LITERALLY VIOLATES THE FIRST AMENDMENT!

AMENDMENT I. Religious establishment prohibited. Freedom of speech, of the press, and right to petition. Congress shall make no law respecting an establishment of religion, or prohibiting the free exercise thereof; or abridging the freedom of speech, or of the press; or the right of the people peaceably to assemble, and to petition the Government for a redress of grievances.

Vatican claims power over ALL Churches:

"No man has a right to choose his religion."

New York Freeman, official journal of Bishop Hughes, Jan 26, 1852.

"The Church...does not, and cannot accept, or in any degree favour, liberty in the Protestant sense of liberty."

Catholic World, April 1870.

"Protestantism has not, and never can have, any right where Catholicity has triumphed."

Catholic Review, June 1875.

"Religious liberty is merely endured until the opposite can be carried into effect without peril to the Catholic Church."

Rt. Rev. O'Connor, Bishop of Pittsburgh.

"It no longer can be said today that the U.S. is a Protestant country."

Cardinal Strich of Chicago quoted in Time Magazine, Aug. 5, 1955"

"It is error to believe that every man is free to embrace and profess that religion which, guided by the light of reason, he shall consider true."

Pope Pius IX, The Syllabus (of Errors), Issued in 1864, Section III, Indifferentism, Latitudinarianism, #15.

"It is error to believe that hence it has been wisely decided by law, in some Catholic countries, that persons coming to reside therein shall enjoy the public exercise of their own peculiar worship."

Pope Pius IX, The Syllabus (of Errors), Issued in 1864, Section X, Errors Having Reference to Modern Liberalism, #78.

"It is error to believe that Moreover, it is false that the civil liberty of every form of worship, and the full power, given to all, of overtly and publicly manifesting any opinions whatsoever and thoughts conduce more easily to corrupt the morals and minds of the people, and to propagate the pest of indifferentism."

Pope Pius IX, The Syllabus (of Errors), Issued in 1864, Section X, Errors Having Reference to Modern LiberalismI, #79.

"This shameful font of indifferentism gives rise to that absurd and erroneous proposition which claims that liberty of conscience must be maintained for everyone. It spreads ruin in sacred and civil affairs, though some repeat over and over again with the greatest impudence that some advantage accrues to religion from it....a pestilence more deadly to the state than any other. Experience shows, even from earliest times, that cities renowned for wealth, dominion, and glory perished as a result of this single evil, namely immoderate freedom of opinion, license of free speech, and desire for novelty. "Here We must include that harmful and never sufficiently denounced freedom to publish any writings whatever and disseminate them to the people, which some dare to demand and promote with so great a clamour. We are horrified to see what monstrous doctrines and prodigious errors are disseminated far and wide in countless books, pamphlets, and other writings which, though small in weight, are very great in malice."

Pope Gregory XVI, Mirari Vos (On Liberalism and Religious Indifferentism), Encyclical promulgated on August 15, 1832, #14 & 15.

Ten Commandments—Catholic Catechism Enlarges on Third [i.e., Fourth]:

Third Commandment of God: Thou shalt keep holy the Lord's Day.

Question: Which is the Lord's Day?
Answer: Sunday, the first day of the week, is the Lord's Day.

On Sunday, God the Father began the creation, God the Son arose from the dead, and the Holy Ghost descended from Heaven.—The Jews observed the last day of the week, the Sabbath, and the apostles, commissioned by our Lord Jesus Christ, substituted for it the first day, the Sunday.

Question: Which days must we keep holy like the Sunday?

Answer: We must keep the Holydays of obligation holy like the Sunday.

Question: Which are the Holydays of obligation in the United States?

Answer: **The Holydays of obligation in the U. S. are:**

- The Immaculate Conception. December 8.
- Christmas. December 25.
- The Circumcision of our Lord. New Year's Day.
- The Ascension of our Lord. 40 days after Easter.
- The Assumption of the Blessed Virgin. August 15.
- All Saints' Day. November 1.

Question: How must we keep holy the Sundays and Holydays of obligation?

Answer: We must keep holy the Sundays and Holydays of obligation

- By not doing any servile work,
- By hearing Mass.

[p. 42] "Six days shalt thou labour, and shalt do all thy works. But on the seventh day is the Sabbath of the Lord, thy God: Thou shalt do no work on it (neither) thou, nor thy son, nor thy daughter, nor thy man-servant, nor thy maid-servant, nor thy beast" (Exod. 20:9, 10).

Servile works = such as are usually done by servants and labourers. Permitted in case of necessity.

Application:
If you desire to have God's blessing, observe the Sunday. Do no unnecessary work. If possible, enter no service where you cannot observe the Sunday as you should. Remember: All depends on God's blessing.

Source: W. Faerber, Catechism for the Catholic Parochial Schools of the United States (15th and 16th ed.; St. Louis: B. Herder, 1913), pp. 41, 42.

Sunday, Observance of, Claimed as Sign That Americans Are a Christian People:

The Divine institution of a day of rest from ordinary occupations and of religious worship, transferred by the authority of the Church from the Sabbath, the last day, to Sunday, the first day of the week, has always been revered in this country, has entered into our legislation and customs, and is one of the most patent signs that we are a Christian people.

The neglect and abandonment of this observance would be sure evidence of a departure from the Christian spirit in which our past national life has been moulded. In our times, as in all times past, the enemies of religion are the opponents, secret or avowed, of the Christian Sabbath.

A close observer cannot fail to note the dangerous inroads that have been made on the Lord's Day in this country within the last quarter of a century. He renders a service to his country who tries to check this dangerous tendency to desecration.

It would not be difficult to show that the observance of Sunday is fraught with the greatest social blessing; as proof, look at the social ills that have befallen those Christian nations that have lost respect for it. Solicitous to avert from the United States those disastrous consequences, the Catholic Church has been a strenuous upholder of the sacred character of the Lord's Day.

Source: James Cardinal Gibbons, "The Claims of the Catholic Church in the Making of the Republic," in John Gilmary Shea and others, The Cross and The Flag, Our Church and Country (New York: The Catholic Historical League of America, 1899), pp. 24, 25. [FRS No. 104.]

Political enforcement (cause) of religious Laws:

"All businesses, including gasoline stations and restaurants should close every Sunday by force of legislative fiat through the duly elected officials of the people."

Christianity Today, Harold Lindsell, Editor may 7, 1976.

"The next obligation that a citizen of God's world order owes is to himself. 'Remember the Sabbath day to keep it Holy' is a command for the personal benefit of each citizen. Higher civilizations rise when people can rest and draw inspiration from God. Laws in America that mandate a day of rest (Sunday Laws) have been nullified as a violation of Church and State…As an outright insult to God and his plan, only those policies that can be shown to have a clearly secular purpose are recognized."

"It is not the duty of any particular group of people, it is not the duty of the Church, but it is the duty of the government of its people to thus proclaim a day as Sabbath to be universally observed throughout the length and breadth of our land."

Robertson, Pat. The New World Order, World publishing, Dallas, 1991, p236.

"All Americans would do well to petition the President and the congress to make a federal Law, and amendment to the Constitution if need be, to establish the Sabbath as a National Day of rest."

Rev Jerry Falwell, Evangelical Baptists Pastor, (August 11, 1933 – May 15, 2007).

"I believe that the United States, as the world's only super power, and the Holy See (Papacy), as the only worldwide moral-political sovereignty have significant roles to play in the future. Their actions will impact the lives of people in all parts of the Globe."

Melady, Thomas P, U.S. Ambassador to the Vatican.